Jothi Teaching Standards

LESSON DELIVERY STANDARD

Operational standard for delivering lessons using the 4T Teaching Engine.

Author
Prakash Micheal
Jothi Learning, United Kingdom

Publication date
March 2026

Document ID
JTS01 -1.0

Purpose of the Document

This document defines the standard for lesson delivery within the Jothi Tutor Academy. Its purpose is to make clear what good teaching looks like in practice and to ensure that lessons are delivered in a way that is structured, diagnostic, responsive, and consistent with the Jothi teaching model.

This standard translates the academy's instructional philosophy into observable tutor behaviour. It is not intended as a generic lesson checklist. It is intended to help tutors understand how to teach in a way that makes student thinking visible and improves learning in real time.

Intended Audience

This document is intended for:

- tutors delivering lessons within Jothi Learning
- mentors observing and coaching tutors
- academy leadership overseeing teaching quality

Related JTA Documents

- JF03 — The 4T Teaching Engine
- JTS02 — Digital Board Teaching Standard
- JTS03 — Assessment and Progress Monitoring Standard
- JTD02 — Tutor Lesson Reflection Standard
- JTD04 — Mentor Observation Standard

1. Purpose of This Standard

Lesson delivery at Jothi is not based on content coverage alone. A lesson is considered effective only when teaching is clear, student understanding is actively checked, reasoning is monitored, and misconceptions are addressed.

For this reason, lesson delivery at Jothi follows the 4T Teaching Engine:

Teach → Test → Track → Transform

This standard defines how that model should appear in live lesson practice.

2. The Role of the 4T Teaching Engine in Lessons

The 4T model is the instructional spine of the lesson.

Teach

The tutor introduces and explains the concept clearly, using logical sequencing and visible reasoning.

Test

The tutor checks understanding through questions or short tasks that reveal whether the student has actually understood the explanation.

Track

The tutor pays attention to how the student is thinking, including their written work, verbal reasoning, hesitation, and error patterns.

Transform

The tutor responds to misunderstanding by correcting the misconception, improving the explanation, and helping the student reach stronger understanding.

These phases may recur several times within one lesson. They should not be treated as a rigid one-time sequence.

3. Standard Lesson Flow

While the exact lesson structure may vary by subject, topic, and student need, a strong Jothi lesson will normally include the following elements:

- retrieval or review of prior learning where appropriate
- clear introduction of the lesson focus
- concept explanation with visible modelling
- diagnostic questioning during and after explanation
- guided practice with active tutor monitoring
- correction of misunderstanding as it appears
- movement toward more independent student performance
- short review or consolidation before the lesson ends

The lesson should feel purposeful and coherent. Students should be able to see what they are learning, why it matters, and where they are struggling.

4. Core Lesson Delivery Expectations

4.1 Clear Concept Explanation

Tutors must explain concepts in a way that is structured, readable, and logically sequenced.

This means:

- breaking ideas into manageable steps

- showing how each step connects to the next
- using examples that expose reasoning, not only final answers
- avoiding unexplained jumps in method

A student should be able to follow the explanation without having to guess what happened between steps.

4.2 Diagnostic Questioning

Tutors must not rely on vague checks such as “Do you understand?” or “Is that clear?” as the main test of understanding.

Instead, tutors should ask questions that reveal student thinking, such as:

- asking the student to explain why a step works
- asking what would change if a condition changes
- asking where an error might occur and why
- asking the student to complete or justify the next step

Diagnostic questioning is one of the clearest indicators of strong teaching at Jothi.

4.3 Monitoring Student Thinking

Tutors must actively observe how the student is processing the lesson.

This includes noticing:

- whether the student is following the logic
- whether they are guessing or reasoning

- whether errors are procedural or conceptual
- whether hesitation suggests uncertainty or weak understanding

Monitoring student thinking is essential because correct answers alone can be misleading.

4.4 Misconception Correction

Tutors must address misunderstanding clearly and promptly.

Correction should not mean simply giving the right answer. It should involve identifying what the student has misunderstood and helping them reconstruct the idea more accurately.

This may involve:

- re-explaining the concept differently
- contrasting correct and incorrect reasoning
- using a simpler example
- asking the student to articulate the corrected idea

4.5 Structured Lesson Progression

Lessons must move with a clear internal logic.

The tutor should maintain a visible flow from explanation to questioning to practice to correction. Lessons should not feel fragmented, improvised, or dominated by tutor monologue.

5. Tutor Behaviour Expectations

Tutors delivering lessons at Jothi are expected to demonstrate the following behaviours consistently.

5.1 Explain with clarity

Use step-by-step explanation and visible reasoning.

5.2 Ask purposeful questions

Use questions to uncover understanding, not merely to fill silence.

5.3 Listen to student reasoning

Pay attention to what the student says, writes, and hesitates over.

5.4 Respond to misunderstanding

Treat errors as information and respond with corrective teaching.

5.5 Keep the lesson intellectually active

Ensure the student is thinking, not only watching.

5.6 Maintain professional conduct

Remain focused, prepared, respectful, and composed throughout the lesson.

6. Subject-Independent Teaching Principles

Although the academy teaches different subjects, certain lesson-delivery principles apply across Mathematics, Physics, and Chemistry.

In all subjects, strong teaching should:

- prioritise understanding over superficial completion
- make reasoning visible

- reveal misconception early
- guide the student through logic, not only procedure
- encourage the student to explain their thinking
- use questioning to diagnose understanding continuously

These principles should remain present regardless of lesson topic or level.

7. Use of the Digital Board in Lesson Delivery

Where digital writing tools are used, the tutor should make full use of them to support explanation and diagnosis.

Board work should:

- be legible and well paced
- show important steps clearly
- help students see the structure of the method
- support discussion of mistakes and misconceptions

The board is not only a display tool. It is part of how the tutor makes thinking visible.

8. Student Participation During Lessons

Students should not remain passive for long stretches of the lesson.

Tutors should regularly invite participation through:

- explanation of reasoning

- completion of steps
- prediction of next moves
- response to diagnostic questions
- identification of errors
- independent or semi-independent working

A strong lesson keeps the student mentally engaged even when the tutor is leading the explanation.

9. Common Teaching Errors

The following behaviours weaken lesson quality and should be actively avoided:

- explaining for too long without checking understanding
- asking only surface-level questions
- moving on after a correct answer without checking reasoning
- correcting work without explaining the misconception
- skipping steps that the student still needs to see
- allowing the lesson to become tutor-centred rather than learning-centred
- focusing on task completion more than conceptual understanding

These errors matter because they make lessons appear smooth while hiding weak learning.

10. What Mentors Should Look For

When observing lesson delivery, mentors should look for evidence that the tutor:

- explains ideas clearly and in logical sequence
- asks questions that reveal student understanding
- notices how the student is reasoning
- identifies and corrects misconceptions effectively
- maintains a coherent lesson flow
- keeps the student actively involved in thinking

This standard is therefore closely linked to mentor observation and tutor reflection.

11. Relationship to the Wider JTA System

This document is the operational lesson standard within the Jothi Tutor Academy. It sits beneath the 4T Teaching Engine and shows how that teaching model should appear in real lessons.

It also supports the wider tutor development process by providing an observable lesson standard against which tutors can reflect, mentors can coach, and competency development can be judged.

12. Conclusion

Effective lesson delivery at Jothi is structured, diagnostic, and responsive. Tutors are expected to do more than explain content. They are expected to reveal student thinking, respond to misunderstanding, and guide students toward stronger understanding.

This standard exists to ensure that lesson quality remains clear, teachable, and consistent across the academy.